

大学英语六级终极押题卷1

重点看翻译写作，时间充足可刷阅读
听力不用做，押中几句话也听辨不出

井书

Part I Writing(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to write an essay that begins with the sentence “It is now widely accepted that mutual trust and openness is the key to promoting cooperation.” You can make comments, cite examples or use your personal experiences to develop your essay. You should write at least 150 words but no more than 200 words

Part II Listening Comprehension (30 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear some questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet 1 with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 to 4 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

1. A) Beautiful scenery in the countryside.
B) Dangers of cross-country skiing.
C) Pain and pleasure in sports.
D) A sport he participates in.
2. A) How quite it is to be out in the woods.
B) How much effort it takes to keep going.
C) Cross-country skiing isn't as simple as some people think.
D) Cross-country skiing takes a lot of energy.
3. A) He can't find good examples to illustrate his point.
B) He can't find a peaceful place to do the assignment.
C) He doesn't know how to describe the beautiful country scenery.
D) He can't decide whether to include the effort part of skiing.
4. A) New ideas come up as you write.
B) Much time is spent on collecting data.
C) A lot of effort is made in vain.
D) The writer's point of view often changes.

Questions 5 to 8 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

5. A) It allows him to make a lot of friends.
B) It requires him to work long hours.
C) It enables him to apply theory to practice.
D) It helps him understand people better.

6. A) It is intellectually challenging.
B) It requires him to do washing-up all the time.
C) It exposes him to oily smoke all day long.
D) It demands physical endurance and patience.
7. A) In a hospital. C) At a laundry.
B) At a coffee shop. D) In a hotel.
8. A) Getting along well with colleagues.
B) Paying attention to every detail.
C) Planning everything in advance.
D) Knowing the needs of customers.

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you will hear 2 passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear some questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet 1 with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 9 to 11 are based on the passage you have just heard.

9. A) State your problem to the head waiter.
B) Demand a discount on the dishes ordered.
C) Ask to see the manager politely but firmly.
D) Ask the name of the person waiting on you.
10. A) Your problem may not be understood correctly.
B) You don't know if you are complaining at the right time.
C) Your complaint may not reach the person in charge.
D) You can't tell how the person on the line is reacting.
11. A) Demand a prompt response. C) Send it by express mail.
B) Provide all the details. D) Stick to the point.

Passage Two

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the passage you have just heard.

12. A) Health and safety conditions in the workplace.
B) Rights and responsibilities of company employees.
C) Common complaints made by office workers.
D) Conflicts between labor and management.
13. A) Replace its out-dated equipment.
B) Improve the welfare of affected workers.
C) Follow government regulations strictly.
D) Provide extra health compensation.
14. A) They requested to transfer to a safer department.
B) They quit work to protect their unborn babies.
C) They sought help from union representatives.
D) They wanted to work shorter hours.

15. A) To show how they love winter sports.
B) To attract the attention from the media.
C) To protest against the poor working conditions.
D) To protect themselves against the cold weather.

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Section C

Directions: In this section, you will hear recordings of lectures or talks followed by some questions. The recordings will be played only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet 1 with a single line through the centre.

Now listen to the following recording and answer questions 16 to 19.

16. A) About how to do experiments.
B) About how to write different kinds of report.
C) About how to read books and journals.
D) About how to understand some characteristic of the experimental reports.
17. A) Past experiments. C) Why you did it.
B) What you did. D) What you found out in the process.
18. A) How you did it. C) What you found out.
B) What you did. D) What you think.
19. A) Collect as much as information in references.
B) Ask friends and colleagues to finish survey.
C) Provide details about how to collect and analyze data.
D) Background sometimes is unnecessary.

Now listen to the following recording and answer questions 20 to 22.

20. A) He spent large part of his life studying Indians.
B) He believes cultures can be classified.
C) He worked on similar research as other anthropologists.
D) He was not interested in the relations between cultures.
21. A) They have less respect for personal space.
B) They pay more attention to individuality.
C) You must knock on doors before entering their rooms.
D) They are more Western-style.
22. A) Time is money. C) The traffic was heavy.
B) I will be there on time. D) Don't waste of time.

Now listen to the following recording and answer questions 23 to 25.

23. A) How to avoid life-threatening accident while walking or driving.
B) How to travel in another country.
C) How to observe behavior in research.
D) How to avoid embarrassment during behavior observation.
24. A) We have to rely on observing samples of people's behavior.
B) Researcher can observe all behaviors.

- C) Situation sampling is more effective than time sampling.
 D) Time sampling is much easier than situation sampling.
25. A) Because situation sampling is time-saving.
 B) Because people may act differently in various situations.
 C) Because situation sampling can choose various time intervals for observation.
 D) Because time sampling is difficult to conduct sometimes.

Part III Reading Comprehension (40 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on Answer Sheet 2 with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.

Questions 26 to 35 are based on the following passage.

As war spreads to many corners of the globe, children sadly have been drawn into the center of conflicts. In Afghanistan, Bosnia, and Colombia, however, groups of children have been taking part in peace education 26 _____. The children, after learning to resolve conflicts, took on the 27 _____ of peacemakers. The Children's Movement for Peace in Colombia was even nominated (提名) for the Nobel Peace Prize in 1998. Groups of children 28 _____ as peacemakers studied human rights and poverty issues in Colombia, eventually forming a group with five other schools in Bogotá known as The Schools of Peace.

The classroom 29 _____ opportunities for children to replace angry, violent behaviors with 30 _____, peaceful ones. It is in the classroom that caring and respect for each person empowers children to take a step 31 _____ toward becoming peacemakers. Fortunately, educators have access to many online resources that are 32 _____ useful when helping children along the path to peace. The Young Peacemakers Club, started in 1992, provides a Website with resources for teachers and 33 _____ on starting a Kindness Campaign. The World Centers of Compassion for Children International call attention to children's rights and how to help the 34 _____ of war. Starting a Peacemakers' Club is a praiseworthy venture for a class and one that could spread to other classrooms and ideally affect the culture of the 35 _____ school.

- | | | |
|-----------------|----------------|------------------|
| A) victims | F) offers | K) entire |
| B) technology | G) information | L) cooperative |
| C) role | H) images | M) comprehensive |
| D) respectively | I) forward | N) assuming |
| E) projects | J) especially | O) acting |

Section B

Directions: In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet 2.

The world has never seen population ageing before. Can it cope?

A) Until the early 1990s nobody much thought about whole populations getting older. The UN had the foresight to convene a "world assembly on ageing" back in 1982, but that came and went. By 1994 the World Bank had noticed that something big was happening. In a report entitled "Averting the Old Age Crisis", it argued that pension arrangements in most countries were unsustainable.

B) For the next ten years a succession of books, mainly by Americans, sounded the alarm. They had titles like *Young vs Old*, *Gray Dawn* and *The Coming Generational Storm*, and their message was blunt: health-care systems were heading for the rocks, pensioners were taking young people to the cleaners, and soon there would be intergenerational warfare.

C) Since then the debate has become less emotional, not least because a lot more is known about the subject. Books, conferences and research papers have multiplied. International organisations such as the OECD and the EU issue regular reports. Population ageing is on every agenda, from G8 economic conferences to NATO summits. The World Economic Forum plans to consider the future of pensions and health care at its prestigious Davos conference early next year. The media, including this newspaper, are giving the subject extensive coverage.

D) Whether all that attention has translated into sufficient action is another question. Governments in rich countries now accept that their pension and health-care promises will soon become unaffordable, and many of them have embarked on reforms, but so far only timidly. That is not surprising: politicians with an eye on the next election will hardly rush to introduce unpopular measures that may not bear fruit for years, perhaps decades.

E) The outline of the changes needed is clear. To avoid fiscal (财政的) meltdown, public pensions and health-care provision will have to be reined back severely and taxes may have to go up. By far the most effective method to restrain pension spending is to give people the opportunity to work longer, because it increases tax revenues and reduces spending on pensions at the same time. It may even keep them alive longer. John Rother, the AARP's head of policy and strategy, points to studies showing that other things being equal, people who remain at work have lower death rates than their retired peers.

F) Younger people today mostly accept that they will have to work for longer and that their pensions will be less generous. Employers still need to be persuaded that older workers are worth holding on to. That may be because they have had plenty of younger ones to choose from, partly thanks to the post-war baby-boom and partly because over the past few decades many more women have entered the labour force, increasing employers' choice. But the reservoir of women able and willing to take up paid work is running low, and the baby-boomers are going grey.

G) In many countries immigrants have been filling such gaps in the labour force as have already emerged (and remember that the real shortage is still around ten years off). Immigration in the developed world is the highest it has ever been, and it is making a useful difference. In still-fertile America it currently accounts for about 40% of total population growth, and in fast-ageing western Europe for about 90%.

H) On the face of it, it seems the perfect solution. Many developing countries have lots of young people in need of jobs; many rich countries need helping hands that will boost tax revenues and keep up economic growth. But over the next few decades labour forces in rich countries are set to shrink so much that inflows of immigrants would have to increase enormously to compensate: to at least twice their current size in western Europe's most youthful countries, and three times in the older ones. Japan would need a large multiple of the few immigrants it has at present. Public opinion polls show that people in most rich countries already think that immigration is too high. Further big increases would be politically unfeasible.

I) To tackle the problem of ageing populations at its root, "old" countries would have to rejuvenate (使年轻) themselves by having more of their own children. A number of them have tried, some more successfully than others. But it is not a simple matter of offering financial incentives or providing more child care. Modern urban life in rich countries is not well adapted to large families. Women find it hard to combine family and career. They often compromise by having just one child.

J) And if fertility in ageing countries does not pick up? It will not be the end of the world, at least not for quite a while yet, but the world will slowly become a different place. Older societies may be less innovative and more strongly disinclined to take risks than younger ones. By 2025 at the latest, about half the voters in America and most of those in western European countries will be over 50—and older people turn out to vote in much greater numbers than younger ones. Academic studies have found no evidence so far that older voters have used their power at the ballot box to push for policies that specifically benefit them, though if in future there are many more of them they might start doing so.

K) Nor is there any sign of the intergenerational warfare predicted in the 1990s. After all, older people themselves mostly have families. In a recent study of parents and grown-up children in 11 European countries, Karsten Hank of Mannheim University found that 85% of them lived within 25km of each other and the majority of them were in touch at least once a week.

L) Even so, the shift in the centre of gravity to older age groups is bound to have a profound effect on societies, not just economically and politically but in all sorts of other ways too. Richard Jackson and Neil Howe of America's CSIS, in a thoughtful book called *The Graying of the Great Powers*, argue that, among other things, the ageing of the developed countries will have a number of serious security implications.

M) For example, the shortage of young adults is likely to make countries more reluctant to commit the few they have to military service. In the decades to 2050, America will find itself playing an ever-increasing role in the developed world's defence effort. Because America's population will still be growing when that of most other developed countries is shrinking, America will be the only developed country that still matters geopolitically (地缘政治上).

Ask me in 2020

N) There is little that can be done to stop population ageing, so the world will have to live with it. But some of the consequences can be alleviated. Many experts now believe that given the right policies, the effects, though grave, need not be catastrophic. Most countries have recognised the need to do something and are beginning to act.

O) But even then there is no guarantee that their efforts will work. What is happening now is historically unprecedented. Ronald Lee, director of the Centre on the Economics and Demography of Ageing at the University of California, Berkeley, puts it briefly and clearly: "We don't really know what population ageing will be like, because nobody has done it yet."

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36. Employers should realise it is important to keep older workers in the workforce.

37. A recent study found that most old people in some European countries had regular weekly contact with their adult children.

38. Few governments in rich countries have launched bold reforms to tackle the problem of population ageing.

39. In a report published some 20 years ago, the sustainability of old-age pension systems in most countries was called into doubt.

40. Countries that have a shortage of young adults will be less willing to send them to war.

41. One-child families are more common in ageing societies due to the stress of urban life and the difficulties of balancing family and career.

42. A series of books, mostly authored by Americans, warned of conflicts between the older and younger generations.

43. Compared with younger ones, older societies tend to be less innovative and take fewer risks.

44. The best solution to the pension crisis is to postpone the retirement age.

45. Immigration as a means to boost the shrinking labour force may meet with resistance in some rich countries.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet 2 with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

"Depression" is more than a serious economic downturn. What distinguishes a depression from a harsh recession is paralyzing fear—fear of the unknown so great that it causes consumers, businesses, and investors to retreat and panic. They save up cash and desperately cut spending. They sell stocks and other assets. A shattering loss of confidence inspires behavior that overwhelms the normal self-correcting mechanisms that usually prevent a recession from becoming deep and prolonged: a depression.

Comparing 1929 with 2007-09, Christina Romer, the head of President Obama's Council of Economic Advisers, finds the initial blow to confidence far greater now than then. True, stock prices fell a third from September to December 1929, but fewer Americans then owned stocks. Moreover, home prices barely dropped. From December 1928 to December 1929, total household wealth declined only 3%. By contrast, the loss in household wealth between December 2007 and December 2008 was 17%. Both stocks and homes, more widely held, dropped more. Thus traumatized (受到创伤) the economy might have gone into a free fall ending in depression. Indeed, it did go into free fall. Shoppers refrained from buying cars, appliances, and

other big-ticket items. Spending on such "durables" dropped at a 12% annual rate in 2008's third quarter, a 20% rate in the fourth. And businesses shelved investment projects.

That these huge declines didn't lead to depression mainly reflects, as Romer argues, countermeasures taken by the government. Private markets for goods, services, labor, and securities do mostly self-correct, but panic feeds on itself and disarms these stabilizing tendencies. In this situation, only government can protect the economy as a whole, because most individuals and companies are involved in the self-defeating behavior of self-protection. Government's failure to perform this role in the early 1930s transformed recession into depression. Scholars will debate which interventions this time—the Federal Reserve's support of a failing credit system, guarantees of bank debt, Obama's "stimulus" plan and bank "stress test"—counted most in preventing a recurrence. Regardless, all these complex measures had the same psychological purpose: to reassure people that the free fall would stop and, thereby, curb the fear that would perpetuate (使持久) a free fall.

All this improved confidence. But the consumer sentiment index remains weak, and all the rebound has occurred in Americans' evaluation of future economic conditions, not the present. Unemployment (9.8%) is abysmal (糟透的), the recovery's strength unclear. Here, too, there is an echo from the 1930s. Despite bottoming out in 1933, the Depression didn't end until World War II. Some government policies aided recovery; some hindered it. The good news today is that the bad news is not worse.

46. Why do consumers, businesses and investors retreat and panic in times of depression?

- A) They suffer great losses in stocks, property and other assets.
- B) They find the self-correcting mechanisms dysfunctional.
- C) They are afraid the normal social order will be paralyzed.
- D) They don't know what is going to happen in the future.

47. What does Christina Romer say about the current economic recession?

- A) Its severity is no match for the Great Depression of 1929.
- B) Its initial blow to confidence far exceeded that of 1929.
- C) It has affected house owners more than stock holders.
- D) It has resulted in a free fall of the prices of commodities.

48. Why didn't the current recession turn into a depression according to Christina Romer?

- A) The government intervened effectively.
- B) Private markets corrected themselves.
- C) People refrained from buying durables and big-ticket items.
- D) Individuals and companies adopted self-protection measures.

49. What is the chief purpose of all the countermeasures taken?

- A) To create job opportunities.
- B) To curb the fear of a lasting free fall.
- C) To stimulate domestic consumption.
- D) To rebuild the credit system.

50. What does the author think of today's economic situation?

- A) It may worsen without further stimulation.

- B) It will see a rebound sooner or later.
- C) It has not gone from bad to worse.
- D) It does not give people reason for pessimism.

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Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

Who's poor in America? That's a question hard to answer. Hard because there's no conclusive definition of poverty. Low income matters, though how low is unclear. Poverty is also a state of mind that fosters self-defeating behavior—bad work habits, family breakdowns, and addictions. Finally, poverty results from bad luck: accidents, job losses, disability.

Despite poverty's messiness, we've measured progress against it by a single statistic: the federal poverty line. By this measure, we haven't made much progress. But the apparent lack of progress is misleading for two reasons.

First, it ignores immigration. Many immigrants are poor and low-skilled. They add to the poor. From 1989 to 2007, about three quarters of the increase in the poverty population occurred among Hispanics (西班牙裔美国人)—mostly immigrants and their children.

Second, the poor's material well-being has improved. The official poverty measure obscures this by counting only pre-tax cash income and ignoring other sources of support, including food stamps and housing subsidies. Although many poor live from hand to mouth, they've participated in rising living standards. In 2005, 91% had microwaves, 79% air-conditioning, and 48% cell phones.

The existing poverty line could be improved by adding some income sources and subtracting some expenses. Unfortunately, the administration's proposal for a "supplemental poverty measure" in 2011 goes beyond that. The new poverty number would compound public confusion. It also raises questions about whether the statistic is tailored to favor a political agenda.

The "supplemental measure" ties the poverty threshold to what the poorest third of Americans spend on food, housing, clothing, and utilities. The actual threshold will probably be higher than today's poverty line. Many Americans would find this weird: people get richer, but "poverty" stays stuck.

What produces this outcome is a different view of poverty. The present concept is an absolute one: the poverty threshold reflects the amount estimated to meet basic needs. By contrast, the new measure embraces a relative notion of poverty: people are automatically poor if they're a given distance from the top, even if their incomes are increasing.

The new indicator is a "propaganda device" to promote income redistribution by showing that poverty is stubborn or increasing. The Census Bureau has estimated statistics similar to the administration's proposal. In 2008, the traditional poverty rate was 13.2%; estimates of the new statistic range up to 17%. The new poverty statistic exceeds the old, and the gap grows larger over time.

As Senator Daniel Moynihan said, the administration is defining poverty up. It's legitimate to debate how much we should aid the poor or reduce economic inequality. But the debate should not be swayed by misleading statistics that few Americans could possibly understand. Government statistics should strive for political neutrality (中立). This one fails.

51. What is the main idea of the first paragraph?

- A) Poverty is very often defined as a state of mind.
- B) Poverty is a problem hard to tackle in America.

- C) Bad work habits and bad luck lead to poverty.
- D) There is no consensus on the concept of poverty.

52. What does the author say about the poor in America?

- A) Their living standards have actually improved.
- B) Most of them are immigrants and their descendants.
- C) Their chances of rising above the poverty line are slim.
- D) Most of them rely on government subsidies for survival.

53. What does the author think of the administration's proposal for a "supplemental poverty measure"?

- A) It is intended to further help the poor.
- B) It is made to serve political purposes.
- C) It is a positive response to changed circumstances.
- D) It is an attempt to combat the economic recession.

54. What is characteristic of the new measure of poverty?

- A) It defines poverty by the gap between the rich and the poor.
- B) It raises the threshold for the poor to get welfare benefits.
- C) It is more accurate and scientific in terms of statistics.
- D) It truly reflects the practical needs of the poor.

55. What does the author want to say by quoting Daniel Moynihan?

- A) Economic equality is but an empty dream.
- B) Political neutrality can never be achieved.
- C) The administration's statistics are biased.
- D) The debate over poverty will get nowhere.

Part V Translation (30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on Answer Sheet 2.

中国的烹饪文化源远流长，起始于商周时期，距今约 3500 年。随着各个时代的经济发展，人们一直在探索烹饪技术。经过历代人民的经验积累，中国现有的菜肴品种有 10000 种之多，烹调方法也有 40 多种。在漫长的历史发展过程中，中国菜逐渐分化为南北两大口味。一般来说，南方菜讲究鲜嫩，而北方由于天气寒冷油重一些，菜中常加醋和大蒜。北方的主食是面条、饺子以及其他面粉做的食物，而大多数南方人则以米饭为主食。